

Introductory Language



Educator Satisfaction Survey

The North Carolina Educator Satisfaction Survey is being conducted by the North Carolina Department of Public Instruction (NCDPI) in compliance with law (§ 115C-269.35(3)). This survey is intended for those who completed an educator preparation program from 2023-2025 and are teaching for the first time in 2026 **since completing the program**.

The purpose of this survey is to gain a better understanding of how teachers feel their program prepared them to meet their professional responsibilities.

Your participation will remain anonymous. Participation of this survey is part of your beginning teacher requirements as outlined in policy. Your participation will help North Carolina formulate evidence-based recommendations to improve the quality of traditional and alternative teacher preparation programs. Responses, in part, are also used in the accountability of educator preparation programs. We hope that you will take advantage of this opportunity to communicate your experience and views.

This survey contains five sections. Estimated time of completion is 15 minutes. If you cannot complete the survey in one sitting, you will be able to return to a partially completed survey without having to start from the beginning by using the link provided in the e-mail. All of the information provided in this survey will be reported only in summary form. Thank you in advance for you time!

If you have any questions regarding this survey please reach out to your Human Resources Department or Charter School Director.

Academic Background and Teacher Preparation

Instructions: Please respond to the items below about your academic background and preparation to teach.

Did you complete a North Carolina traditional teacher preparation program **prior** to beginning to teach?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

For the preparation category selected, please indicate the school year in which you completed your teacher preparation.

- ☐ 2024-2025
- ☐ 2023-2024
- ☐ 2022-2023
- ☐ Other
- ☐ Not yet completed preparation

Thank you for agreeing to participate in this survey. By indicating you have not yet completed your educator preparation program, this survey is now concluded. We will reengage you on a future survey when you are program complete and can provide the best perspective on its content.

Is this your first year of teaching **following** program completion?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Thank you for agreeing to participate in this survey. By indicating you are not in your first year of teaching on the previous question, the survey is now concluded. This instrument is intended to capture only those beginning teachers engaged in their first year of teaching.

Are you currently teaching in a grade-level or subject-area in which you were prepared to teach?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Quality of Teacher Preparation

Quality of Teacher Preparation

Instructions: Please respond to the items below about the quality of your teacher preparation. When responding, please answer in reference to the teacher preparation that led to your initial teaching license.

How well did your teacher preparation program prepare you to:

	Not addressed	Not well	Somewhat well	Well	Very well
Set challenging and appropriate goals for student learning and performance	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Empower students to become self-directed and productive learners	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Maintain discipline and an orderly, purposeful learning environment	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Develop positive and supportive relationships with students	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Create an environment of high expectations for all students	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Not addressed	Not well	Somewhat well	Well	Very well
Teaching in ways that support English language learners	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

How well did your teacher preparation program prepare you to:

	Not addressed	Not well	Somewhat well	Well	Very well
Teach in ways that support students with diverse ethnic, racial, cultural, and socioeconomic backgrounds	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Teach in ways that support special education students	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Teach in ways that support academically gifted students	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Develop a classroom environment that promotes respect and group responsibility	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Teach the concepts, knowledge, and skills of your discipline(s)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Align instruction with state standards	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

How well did your teacher preparation program prepare you to:

	Not addressed	Not well	Somewhat well	Well	Very well
Relate classroom teaching to the real world	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Develop lessons that build on students' experiences, interests, and abilities	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Develop a variety of assessments (e.g. tests, observations, portfolios, performance tasks)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Provide purposeful feedback to students to guide their learning	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Differentiate instruction	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Use technology in the classroom to improve learning outcomes	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

How well did your teacher preparation program prepare you to:

	Not addressed	Not well	Somewhat well	Well	Very well
Help students think critically and solve problems	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Develop students' questioning and discussion skills	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Analyze student performance data to improve instruction	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Adapt practice based on research and student performance data	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Self-assess and reflect on own practices	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Collaborate with colleagues to improve student learning	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Work with parents and families to better understand students and support their learning	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

How valuable were the following aspects of your teacher preparation program?

	Not a part of my teacher preparation program	Not at all valuable	Not very valuable	Somewhat valuable	Valuable	Very valuable
Program coursework	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fieldwork	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Student teaching experiences	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Instructors of your classes	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Please select the **THREE** items that would have most improved the quality of your teacher preparation.

- ☐ More exposure to a variety of school environments (e.g. urban vs rural, low vs. high-poverty)
- ☐ More coaching and feedback during student teaching
- ☐ More opportunities to learn about and practice classroom management
- ☐ More opportunities to learn about and practice instructional planning
- ☐ More opportunities to learn about and develop assessments
- ☐ More opportunities to learn about and practice differentiated classroom instruction
- ☐ More opportunities to analyze student learning to inform instruction
- ☐ More opportunities to learn about and practice non-teaching tasks (e.g. communicating with parents, developing IEPs, etc.)
- ☐ More guidance on task/time management
- ☐ Other (Please specify)

Opportunities to Learn

Instructions: Please respond to the items below about your opportunities to learn and practice during your teacher preparation. When responding, please answer in reference to the teacher preparation that led to your initial teaching license.

In your teacher preparation program, how much opportunity did you have to:

	No opportunity	Few opportunitites	Some opportunities	Many opportunities	Extensive opportunities
Study stages of child development and learning	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Develop strategies for managing student misbehavior	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Develop strategies for establishing classroom procedures	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Develop strategies for teaching English language learners	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Develop strategies for teaching students from diverse ethnic, racial, cultural, and socioeconomic backgrounds	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Develop strategies for teaching students with special needs	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Develop strategies for teaching students who are academically gifted	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

In your teacher preparation program, how much opportunity did you have to:

	No opportunity	Few opportunities	Some opportunities	Many opportunities	Extensive opportunities
Develop strategies for teaching students of varying ability	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Apply state or national standards to instruction	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Plan units and lessons	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Create formative and summative student assessments	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Analyze student assessment data/work to adjust instruction	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	No opportunity	Few opportunities	Some opportunities	Many opportunities	Extensive opportunities
Provide meaningful and specific academic feedback to students	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Develop instructional strategies to promote students' critical thinking skills	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Literacy Preparation

Instructions: Please respond to the items below about your preparation to teach literacy.

Were you prepared to teach kindergarten through fifth grade students to read?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

How well did your teacher preparation program prepare you to:

	Not addressed	Not well	Somewhat well	Well	Very well
Develop students' concepts of print to support their reading and writing skills	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Develop students' oral language through an emphasis on reading, writing, speaking, and listening	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Teach students how to recognize and manipulate phonemes	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Teach students how to map individual sounds to printed letters	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Teach students how to decode words	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

How well did your teacher preparation program prepare you to:

	Not addressed	Not well	Somewhat well	Well	Very well
Develop students' reading fluency through understanding the relationships between accuracy, decoding, and word recognition	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Teach oral and written vocabulary using a variety of approaches, including teaching individual words and	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Not addressed	Not well	Somewhat well	Well	Very well
word learning strategies					
Develop students' reading comprehension through the interconnectedness of proficient word reading, background knowledge, language, and vocabulary	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Develop reading comprehension for students at different levels of language and literacy	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Design instruction that integrates reading and writing and acknowledges their interconnectedness	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

In your teacher preparation program, how much opportunity did you have to:

	No opportunity	Few opportunities	Some opportunities	Many opportunities	Extensive opportunities
Observe literacy instruction focused on phonics, phonemic awareness, fluency, vocabulary, and comprehension	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Implement literacy instruction with teacher educators (e.g. program faculty) and peers focused on phonics, phonemic awareness, fluency, vocabulary, and comprehension	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Implement literacy instruction with K-12 students focused on phonics, phonemic awareness, fluency, vocabulary, and comprehension	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Assess students' literacy development and analyze progress monitoring data to inform instruction	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Receive substantive and actionable feedback on your literacy instruction	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Student Teaching

Instructions: Please respond to the items below about your student teaching experiences.

Did your educator preparation program include supervised student teaching?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

In what NC school district was your supervised student teaching experience?

In what NC school was your supervised student teaching experience?

Please respond to the items below about the extent to which the following statements describe your student teaching experiences.

Teachers I observed during my student teaching experience...

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither	Agree	Strongly agree
Had extensive knowledge of the curriculum material covered	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Had extensive knowledge of pedagogical methods	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Taught in ways that were quite different from the methods I learned in my courses	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Modeled effective classroom management strategies	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

My cooperating teacher...

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither	Agree	Strongly agree
Modeled effective teaching strategies	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Helped me understand the academic content of the grade-level/subject-area	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Modeled effective classroom management strategies	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Met regularly with me to discuss my progress	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Provided me with useful feedback about	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither	Agree	Strongly agree
my teaching					
Allowed me to implement the strategies and techniques I learned in my preparation courses	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

My supervised student teaching experience was similar to my current job in terms of...

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither	Agree	Strongly agree
Student demographics (e.g. student race/ethnicity, economically disadvantaged, English learner status, exceptional children status, etc.)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Student performance	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Job Satisfaction and Supports

Instructions: Please respond to the items below about your job satisfaction, teaching supports, and plans to continue teaching in North Carolina schools.

In general, I am satisfied with my current job

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neither
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

I consider teaching to be my ideal career

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Neither
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree

If someone could change any of the following items, which ones would be most important to improve your satisfaction with your job? Choose at least one and no more than three items.

- ☐ Mentor support
- ☐ Colleague support
- ☐ Administrator support
- ☐ Student behavior
- ☐ Fewer mandated assessments

- ☐ Your instructional resources
- ☐ Your teaching assignment
- ☐ Your overall workload
- ☐ Parental support
- ☐ Professional development
- ☐ Opportunities to assume leadership roles
- ☐ More autonomy over instructional decisions
- ☐ Salary
- ☐ Health and retirement benefits
- ☐ Other (Please Specify)

In your current school have you been formally assigned a mentor?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Does your mentor teach the same grade-level and/or subject-area as you?

- ☐ Same grade only
- ☐ Same subject-area only
- ☐ Same grade and subject-area
- ☐ Neither

How often did you engage in each of the following activities with your mentor in the current school year?

	Never	Less than once per month	Once per month	Several times a month	Once a week	Almost daily
Being observed by my mentor	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Observing my mentor's teaching	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Planning instruction with my mentor	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Reflecting on the effectiveness of my teaching with my mentor	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Co-teaching with my mentor	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

How much did your mentor's support influence your practice in the following areas?

	Not at all	Hardly at all	Some	Quite a bit	A great deal
Unit and lesson planning	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Pedagogical strategies	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Classroom management	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Not at all	Hardly at all	Some	Quite a bit	A great deal
Assessing students' learning	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Reflection and professional growth	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Please answer the following questions about your mentor.

	Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither	Agree	Strongly agree
I have a strong professional relationship with my mentor	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My mentor provides individualized support based on my needs	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I always implement the suggestions and advice my mentor gives me	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Of the success you have had as a beginning teacher, what amount would you attribute to help from your mentor?

- ☐ None
- ☐ Hardly any
- ☐ Some
- ☐ Quite a bit
- ☐ A great deal